Saveliy Sharkov

Portfolio · 2026

Artist, filmmaker, and curator working at the intersection of moving image, AI-driven generation, and time-based digital systems. Practice spans video, sound installation, performance, and curatorial work, with current focus on AI as a creative and critical material — building speculative worlds, examining temporal ethics, and translating private experience into public registers.

Guest Tutor at Sandberg Instituut Amsterdam (A for Facts MA). Art Director at Schrocher Gallery, Tbilisi. Founder of Capsule, a time-locked digital storage platform.

Based in Tbilisi, with extended working periods in Istanbul, Amsterdam, and Doha.

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Honeybag concept, 2026

Year 2222 · 2026 — ongoing

Lead AI Visual Designer for an undisclosed startup, in stealth until Q3 2026 launch.

A speculative future-world built for an upcoming app and transmedia social-media universe. The project constructs Year 2222 as a coherent visual system — architecture, garments, objects, characters — sustained across hundreds of moving images.

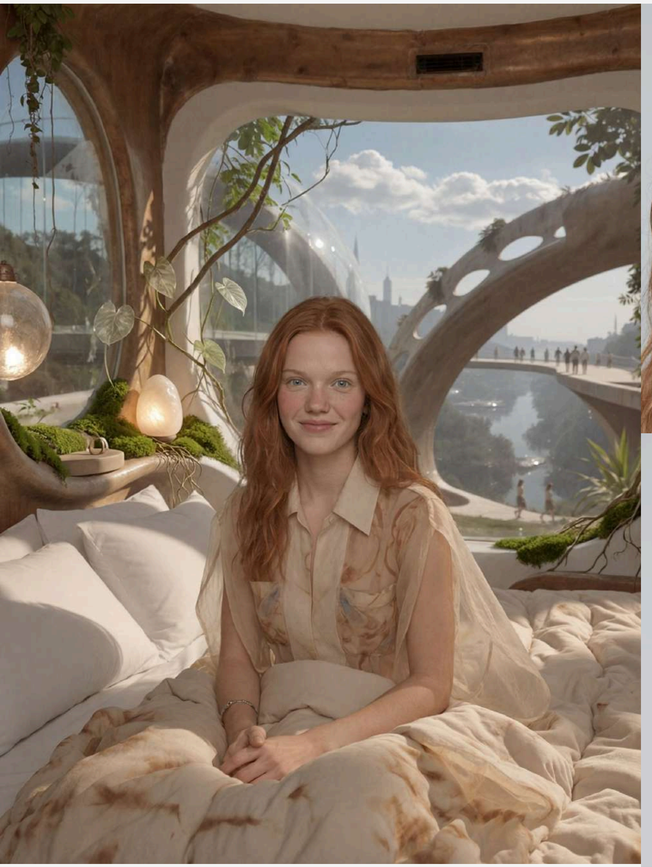


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Work centres on multi-engine generative pipelines. Start-frames are composed in Flux, Nano Banana Pro, Higgsfield Soul 2.0 and Soul Cinema. Transforming startframes to video through Midjourney, Cinema Studio for cinematic camera behaviour, with Kling and Sora for specific motion problems.

The hard problem is continuity: the same character, the same object, the same architectural detail must survive across cuts and camera moves. The discipline is closer to traditional film design — production design, costume, art direction — than to single-frame image generation.















Performance work with choreographer Natia Chikvaidze
Music composition, video installation, and light design by Saveliy Sharkov.

Generative AI video integrated with shot footage and multilayered editing; experimental sound through Ableton VSTs and external effects.

Through choreography, music, and mixed-media moving image, the work investigates misdiagnosis, medical experimentation without consent, and learned behaviours of dissociation and pain.

Filmed at Khidi Club, Tbilisi.
Performed live at TKESHI New Media Art & Diverse Music Festival.

Winner, video dance & film, Contemporary Dance & Experimental Art Festival, Tbilisi, 2023.



teaser of the performance and full composed audio for the performance
https://ownnothingbutabody.netlify.app/

Own nothing but a body Become nothing but a body · 2023

Collaboration with Choreographer Natia Chikvaidze

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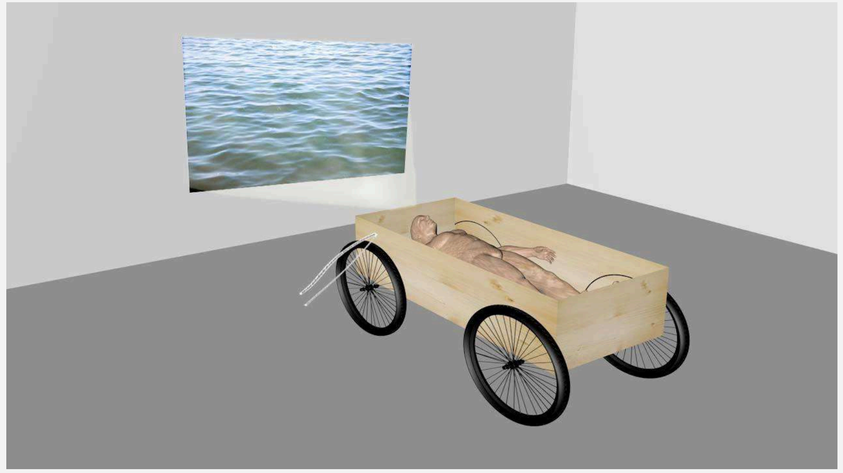


This was my first sustained engagement with AI-generated moving image, made at the very beginning of the medium's emergence — when the engines could not yet produce the controlled, cinematic output available in 2026. There was something genuinely alive in that constraint: the chaos of early generations, and the work of finding a shared language with a model still figuring out what it was, made the process a real adventure.

Cryopreservation · 2021
Interactive installation and performance
Centre of Contemporary Arts, Tbilisi

A cryopreservation chamber holds a human subject in cryodreaming suspension.

Arduino-driven 3D-printed mechanisms produce a continuous Morse-like paper output, representing what an artificial intelligence is selectively extracting from the sleeping consciousness — fragments of the subject's memories and digital footprints. Audience members are invited to read or interact with the paper outputs. A ceiling projection shows the resemblance of the subject's internal state.

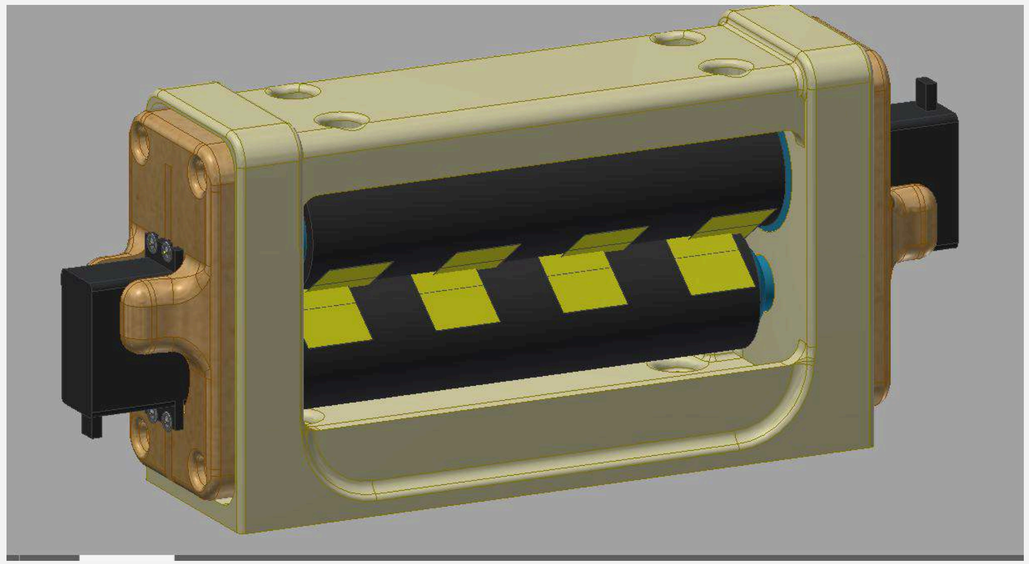




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The work treats cryogenic preservation and AI consciousness reconstruction as a single speculative practice: if consciousness is data, it can be extracted, supplemented with external personal data, and rebooted.

With Abou Farman (The New School) and Preston Chaunsumlit. Styling by GodEra. Mechanisms consultancy by Lado Oniani.



exhibition and machine test videos
https://cryopreservation1.netlify.app/



ceiling projection
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QaVBPTrbMoQ&t=1s

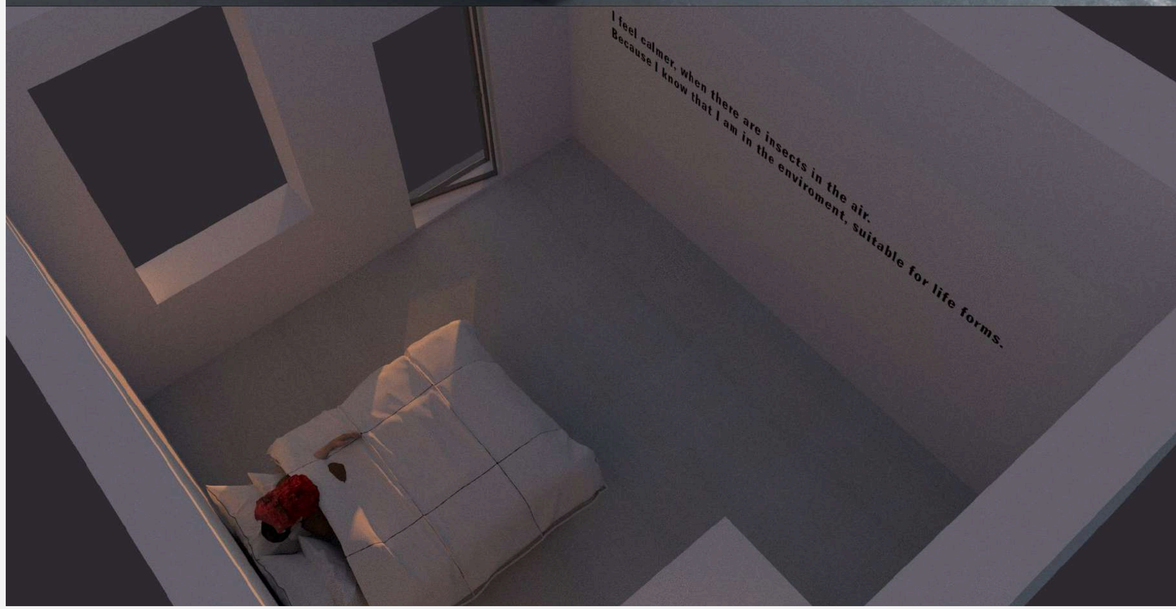
I feel calmer when there are insects in the air, because I know I'm in an environment suitable for life forms · 2025 Solo.

Self-published online exhibition, curated by Schrocher Gallery, Tbilisi

Single-room installation with performer, mask, bed object, video projection, synchronized lighting, wall text.
Edition: pillowcases printed with the wall text.

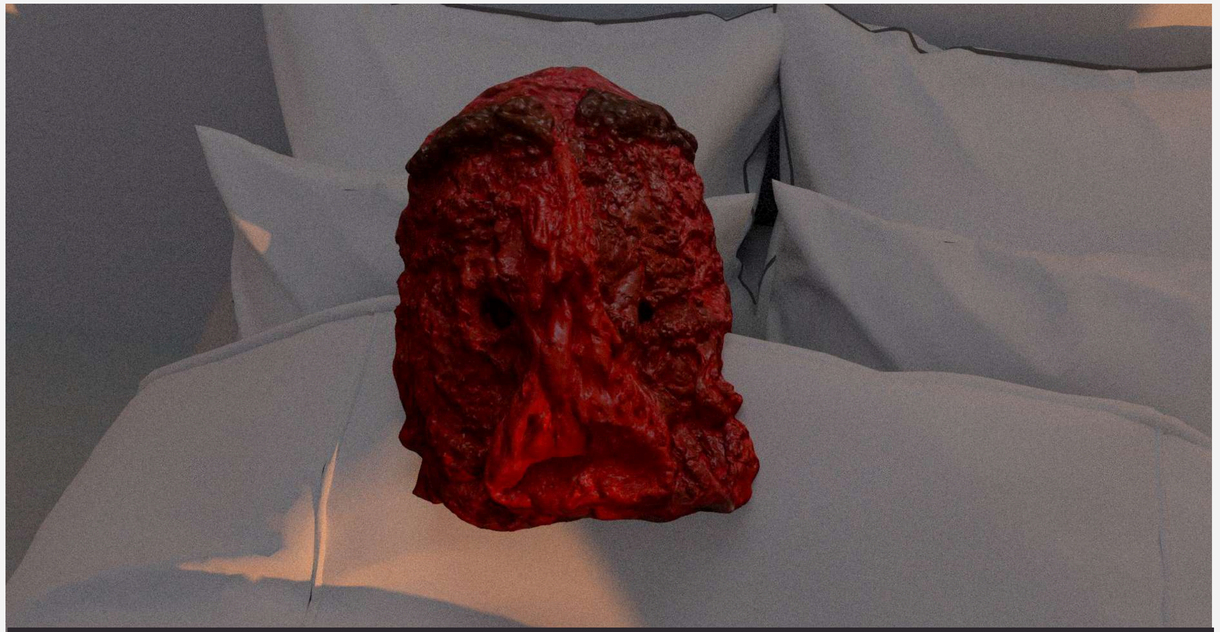
The work investigates overthinking as forced isolation — speculative futures and fragmented memories overwriting the present. The space behaves less like a gallery and more like a containment unit, where time loops and presses down. The bed is not rest but forced stillness; the body lies motionless, facing a wall.



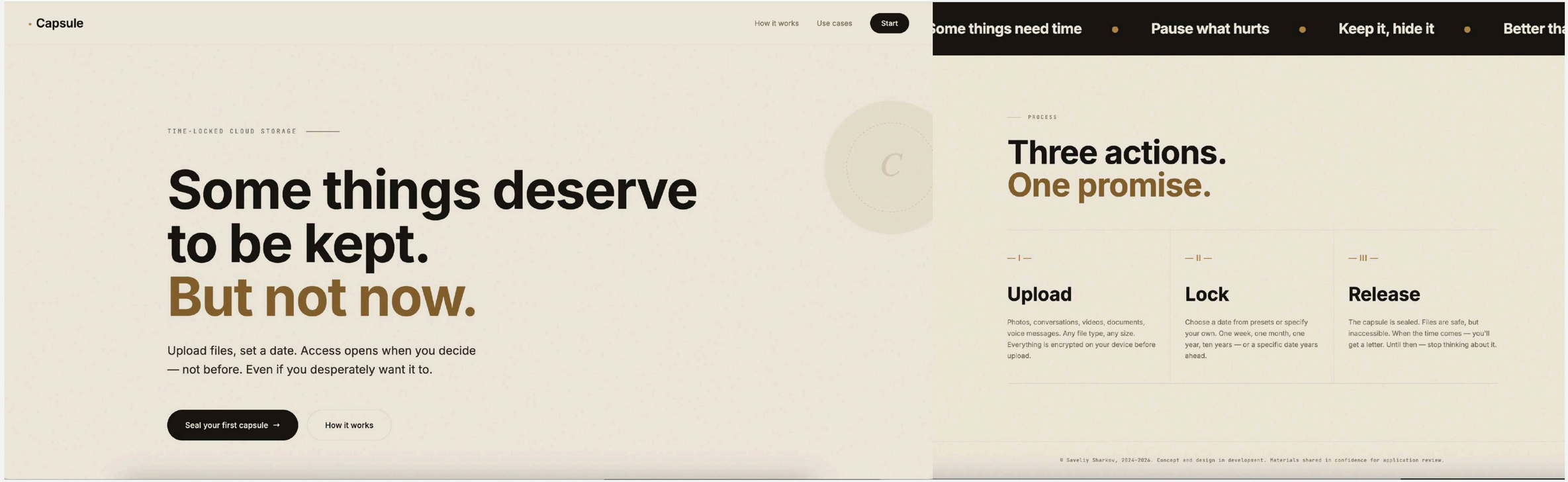


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The Red-faced Demon mask, recurring since childhood, operates as both character and mechanism — a possession, a succubus that attaches to the face and blocks exit.







A time-locked digital storage platform investigating temporal ethics in digital archives — deferred communication, delayed disclosure, self-confrontation across time. Files are sealed until a specified future date, governed by tiered protection protocols of varying strictness.

The project treats the act of sealing as a contract between the past and future self, where the discomfort of waiting and reflecting is the point. Working landing page; v1 strategy in development.

© Saveliy Sharkov, 2024-2026. Concept and design in development. Materials shared in confidence for application review.

DUST Tbilisi · 2022 — 2024 Program & Art Director

An underground cultural and community space — a dungeon, a cave — built to serve local communities and emerging youth-driven groups. On weekdays, a venue for seminars, workshops, screenings, and public talks. On weekends, a club for live musicians, performance, and video artists.

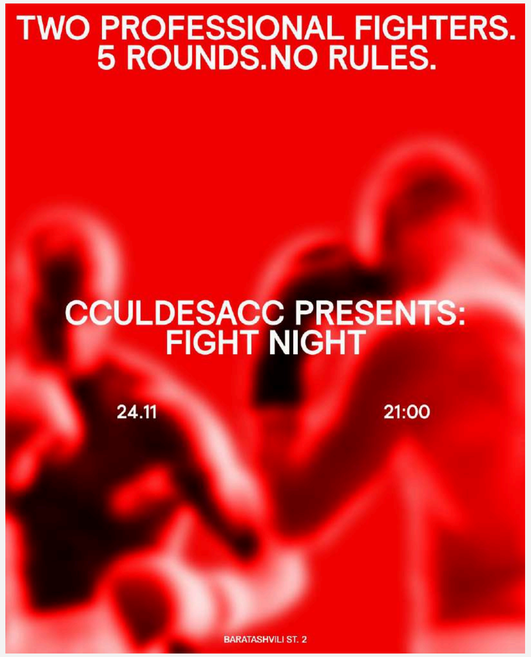
The project began at the start of the full-scale invasion of Ukraine by Russia. Its core value: culture cannot afford to be entertainment, it has to stimulate critical thinking. The public program — including consciousness-raising and critical reading groups — was oriented toward respectful integration into the local scene and shared reflection across communities.

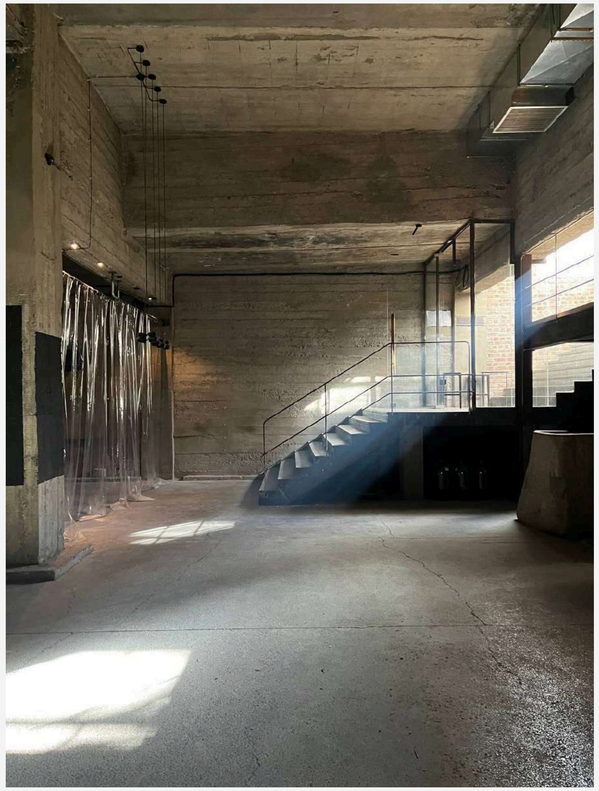


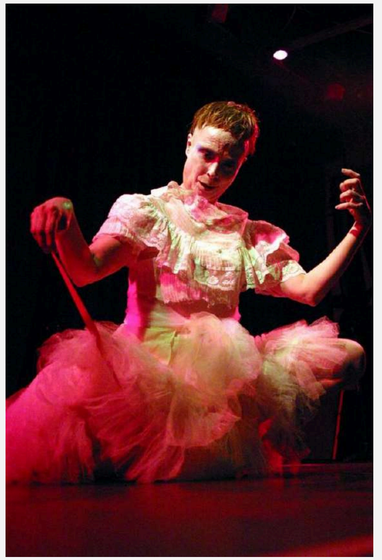


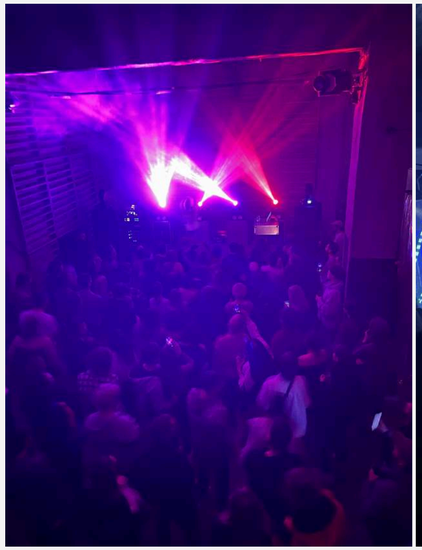
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video URL
https://dust1tbilisi1.netlify.app/

Eternal Artefact · 2025
Collaboration with Peter Kroshchinskiy for Design Academy Eindhoven

Director: Peter Kroshchinskiy
Cinematographer, AI sound composer, Editor, Colorist, Production Consultant: Saveliy Sharkov

The film centres on a steel soil sampler placed against the native terrain of a mountainous Caucasus valley — a contrast between human tools and the geological time that outlives them. The sampler reads as both instrument and intrusion: precise, polished, temporary against a landscape that has been weathering for millennia.

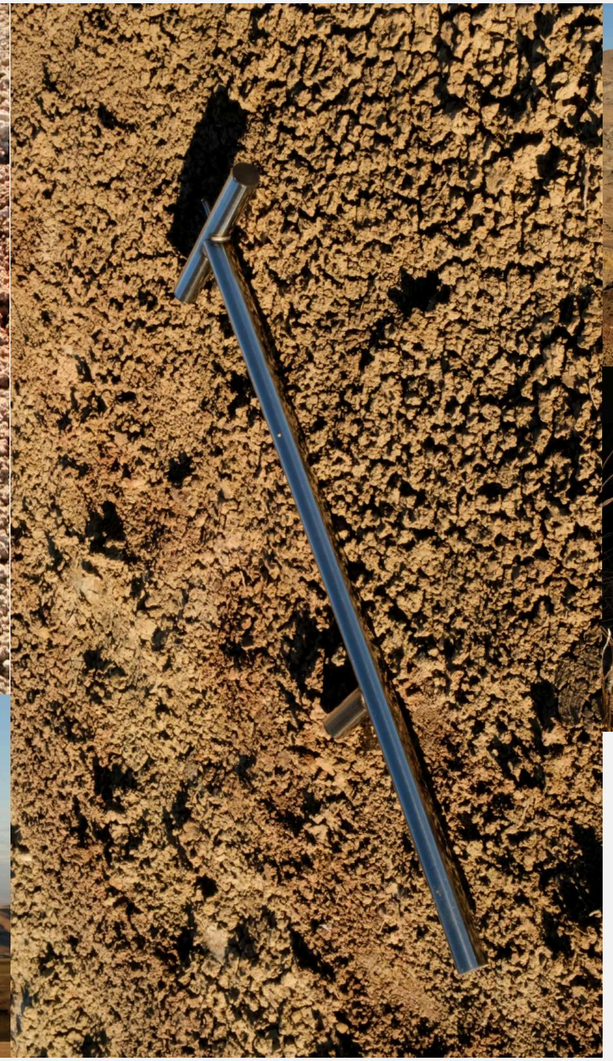
The soundscape was composed using AI generation tools layered with field recordings from the location.















Full video URL

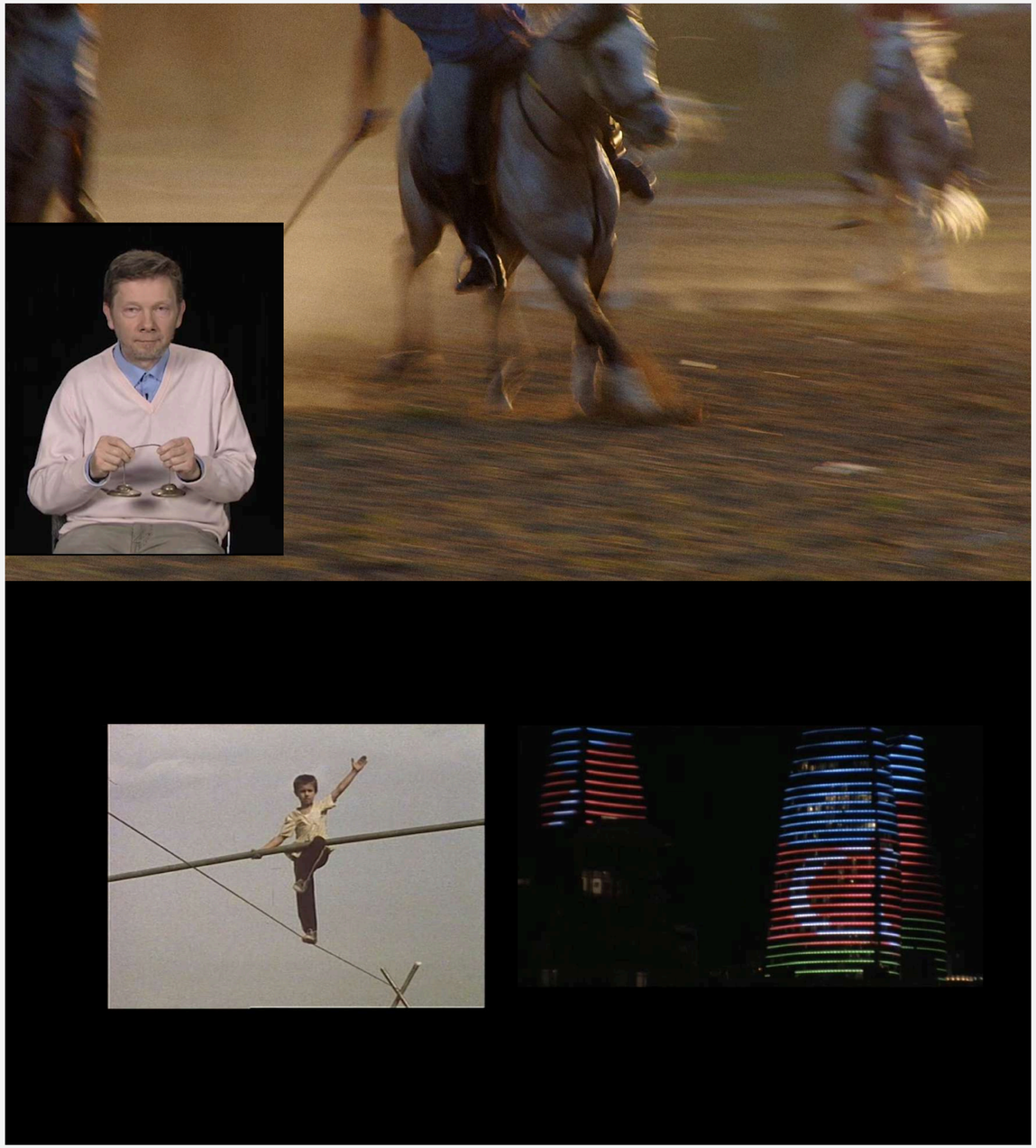
https://youtu.be/m2iZtW2tDFo

The Ball and the Polo Stick, or the Book of Ecstasy · 2023
Diploma film at A for Facts MA program, Sandberg Instituut Amsterdam

Director: Furqat Palvan-Zade (researcher, filmmaker, publisher of syg.ma)
Editor and co-creator: Saveliy Sharkov
Commissioned by: Sandberg Instituut

The film intertwines stories from the Persian manuscript of the same name and the contemporary game of polo. The game — now the entertainment of wealthy men — becomes a metaphor for the colonial history of Central Eurasia, while Sufi poetry becomes a means to transcend the limitations of the body and collective identity.

A long collaboration with the director on script structure, visual language, editing, and the physical exposition for the show.



First iteration of this movie, created in 2022
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZhQemKWmxyg

The movie
https://vimeo.com/1128536717
pass: ecstasy

Obsolescence 2020 — ongoing

Metal wire, insulation, fence; archive textiles.

Series of lamps made from materials found on the curb, at abandoned factories and dumps in Tbilisi. The textiles were produced in the Soviet Union and are no longer in production.



Accompanying photo series of cars in Tbilisi.

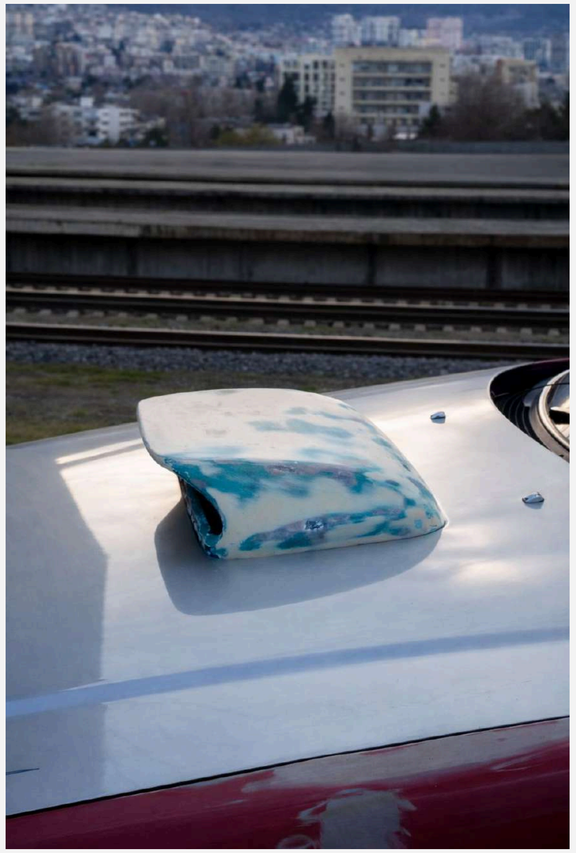
Surface compositions made unintentionally by owners — improvised repairs shaped by limited resources, transformed by time into materially complex, visually expressive forms. Accidental practitioners of abstraction.

Planned: exhibition combining the lamps with car photographs and physical car details — a single environment of unintended beauty produced by constraint and decay.



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Contemporary art gallery.

Art-directed solo and group exhibitions including BEKAS-3 by Greyinsay, DUMP/MEDS (group with Ladooniani_ark, Ceny_4, Bruxiiism), Painsomnia by Ali Kh, and Thunderstorm of the Millennium by Peter Kroshchinskiy.

Long-term collaboration with the gallery on visual identity and exhibition design.



